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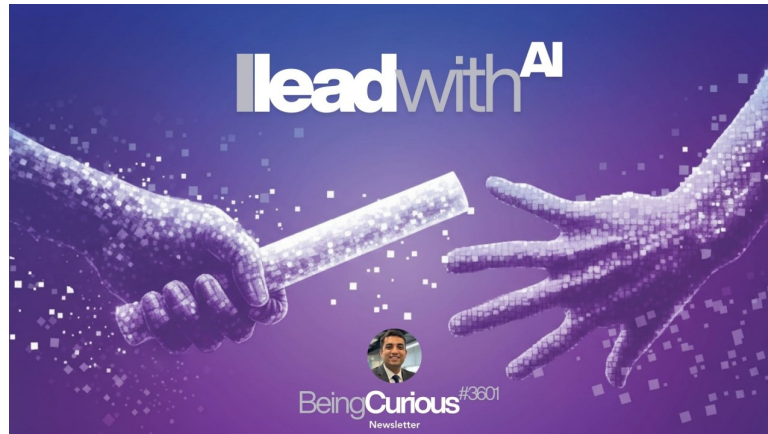
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Lead with AI

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Hello Curious Minds,

The leaders of tomorrow will not just use AI—they will lead with it.

AI is no longer a side project. It's becoming the **foundation for how businesses operate, innovate, and compete**. But here's the real question: **Are we ready to lead with AI—or are we still experimenting on the surface?**

Leading with AI is not about adopting a few tools or chasing trends. It's about **embedding AI into the way we think, decide, and deliver value**. That requires a strong foundation.

Here are **3 essentials that I believe matter the most (and why)**:

1. Build an AI Mindset First It starts in the way we approach problems. Instead of asking *"How do we automate this?"*, start asking *"How would this process look if AI was at the core?"* Look at **McKinsey**—they built an internal AI platform called *Lilli* that now answers 70% of knowledge queries across the firm and saves **tens of thousands of consultant hours every month**. That's not a tool adoption—it's a mindset shift.

2. Get Your Data House in Order We often jump to AI models, but the truth is, **AI is only as good as the data behind it**. A recent Gartner study revealed that **80% of AI projects fail** because organizations underestimate the complexity of data readiness. If your data is

underestimate the complexity of data readiness. If your data is fragmented, inconsistent, or locked in silos, AI will give you nothing more than flashy demos. **Clean, connected, and governed data isn't glamorous—but it's the backbone.** Without it, scale is impossible. Amazon's success in personalization wasn't magic—it was decades of investment in **data infrastructure** that allowed AI to deliver relevant recommendations at scale.

3. Make It About People, Not Just Tech AI doesn't replace humans—it **amplifies human potential**. The real win is when people learn how to work with AI, not against it. Look at **Goldman Sachs**—they rolled out AI copilots to bankers, but paired it with targeted upskilling programs so employees knew how to use it effectively. The result? Better decisions, faster deals, and stronger client outcomes. The future will belong to **teams that combine human judgment with machine intelligence seamlessly.**

Channelizing Into All Things AI

So, what does *leading with AI* look like beyond these three essentials? It means going beyond isolated pilots and embedding AI across **strategy, operations, and culture**:

◆ **In Strategy** – Use AI for scenario planning, forecasting, and competitive intelligence. Boards and CEOs should have AI-driven insights as part of every strategic conversation. McKinsey calls this **hybrid strategy development**, where AI accelerates research and humans drive judgment.

◆ **In Operations** – Think predictive supply chains, dynamic pricing, automated compliance, AI-driven customer engagement. For example, **Unilever** uses AI for demand forecasting, reducing waste and improving accuracy across markets.

◆ **In Innovation** – Generative AI isn't just about text or images. It's being used for **drug discovery, product design, and code generation**. The companies that build AI into their R&D engines will lead the next decade of breakthroughs.

◆ **In Culture** – Foster curiosity and openness. Create AI literacy programs, encourage experimentation, and make AI a part of daily work conversations—not just an IT agenda.

Because here's the truth: **AI is no longer an IT initiative; it's a business transformation initiative.**

So, if there's one takeaway, it's this: The leaders who **channelize into all things AI**—from mindset to data to culture—will shape the future of their industries. The rest will be playing catch-up.

Your turn: *What's one area in your business or role where you see AI making the biggest impact in the next 12 months?*

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I'm fully aligned with your perspective—not just on adopting AI, but on enabling ourselves through it. While many are focused solely on developing AI solutions, the real emphasis should be on how AI can enhance existing solutions and maximize the value they deliver. A strong example is Microsoft, which has achieved significant effi ...more

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